

Nova Collaborative

Gig Worker Contract Safety Tracker

Product Backlog — Approved MVP

Product Goal: Provide freelancers and independent contractors with a secure centralized platform to manage contracts, invoices, milestones, payment status, reminders and evidence needed during payment disputes.

North Star Metric: Reduction in nonpayment/wage-theft incidence among active users.

Priority: P0 = Must Have; P1 = Should Have; P2 = Future / Out of MVP.

Scope note: The approved charter is the baseline. Native Android/iOS apps and freelance-platform integrations are not MVP commitments; integration/data-standardisation items are retained as future backlog items.

EPIC 1 — User Authentication & Account Management

ID	Backlog Item	User Story / Description	Priority
AUTH-01	User Registration	As a freelancer, I want to create an account so that I can securely manage my projects and records.	P0
AUTH-02	User Login	As a freelancer, I want to log in securely so that only I can access my records.	P0
AUTH-03	Logout	As a user, I want to securely log out so that my account cannot be accessed from an unattended session.	P0
AUTH-04	Password Reset	As a user, I want to reset my password when I forget it.	P0
AUTH-05	User Profile	As a freelancer, I want to manage my profile information.	P1
AUTH-06	Session Management	As a user, I want my session to be securely managed so that my account remains protected.	P0
AUTH-07	Multi-Factor Authentication	As a freelancer, I want an additional authentication factor to protect my account.	P0

EPIC 2 — Client & Project Management

ID	Backlog Item	User Story / Description	Priority
PROJ-01	Create Client	As a freelancer, I want to create a client record so that I can associate projects and contracts with the correct client.	P0
PROJ-02	Edit Client	As a freelancer, I want to update client information.	P1
PROJ-03	Create Project	As a freelancer, I want to create a project under a client so that related contracts, milestones and invoices remain organized.	P0
PROJ-04	Project Details	As a freelancer, I want to view project information and related records in one place.	P0
PROJ-05	Project Search & Filtering	As a freelancer, I want to search/filter my projects so that I can find records quickly.	P1

EPIC 3 — Secure Contract Management

ID	Backlog Item	User Story / Description	Priority
CONT-01	Upload Contract	As a freelancer, I want to upload a contract so that I have a centralized record of my agreement.	P0
CONT-02	Contract Metadata	As a freelancer, I want to record contract/client/project information so that documents are easy to identify.	P0
CONT-03	Contract Categorization	As a freelancer, I want to categorize contracts so that I can organize my records.	P1
CONT-04	Contract Search	As a freelancer, I want to search my contracts so that I can quickly locate an agreement.	P1
CONT-05	Contract Filtering	As a freelancer, I want to filter contracts by client/project/status/date.	P1
CONT-06	Contract Download/View	As a freelancer, I want to view/download my stored contract when needed.	P0

ID	Backlog Item	User Story / Description	Priority
CONT-07	Secure Contract Storage	As a freelancer, I want my contracts stored securely so that unauthorized people cannot access them.	P0

EPIC 4 — Contract Version History

ID	Backlog Item	User Story / Description	Priority
VER-01	Upload New Contract Version	As a freelancer, I want to upload a revised contract without deleting the original.	P0
VER-02	Automatic Version Number	As a freelancer, I want each revision automatically numbered.	P0
VER-03	Version Timestamp	As a freelancer, I want each version to have an upload timestamp.	P0
VER-04	Change Description	As a freelancer, I want to describe what changed between versions.	P1
VER-05	View Previous Versions	As a freelancer, I want to access previous contract versions.	P0
VER-06	Contract Audit History	As a freelancer, I want a record of contract activity so that I can establish what was agreed and when.	P0

EPIC 5 — Invoice Creation & Management

ID	Backlog Item	User Story / Description	Priority
INV-01	Create Invoice	As a freelancer, I want to create an invoice for work completed.	P0
INV-02	Link Invoice to Contract	As a freelancer, I want an invoice linked to its contract so that payment records have context.	P0
INV-03	Link Invoice to Milestone	As a freelancer, I want an invoice associated with the relevant milestone.	P0
INV-04	Client Association	As a freelancer, I want an invoice associated with the correct client/project.	P0
INV-05	Invoice Amount	As a freelancer, I want to specify the amount I am owed.	P0
INV-06	Invoice Due Date	As a freelancer, I want to assign a payment due date.	P0
INV-07	Edit Invoice	As a freelancer, I want to edit an invoice before it is finalized/sent.	P1
INV-08	Invoice Archive	As a freelancer, I want to access historical invoices.	P1

EPIC 6 — Payment Status Tracking

ID	Backlog Item	User Story / Description	Priority
PAY-01	Pending Status	As a freelancer, I want unpaid invoices to display as Pending.	P0
PAY-02	Paid Status	As a freelancer, I want to mark/record an invoice as Paid.	P0
PAY-03	Overdue Status	As a freelancer, I want overdue invoices identified automatically.	P0
PAY-04	Payment Status History	As a freelancer, I want previous status changes recorded.	P0
PAY-05	Payment Validation	As a freelancer, I want payment status changes protected from unauthorized modification.	P0
PAY-06	Outstanding Payment View	As a freelancer, I want to see outstanding payments in one place.	P0

EPIC 7 — Milestone Tracking

ID	Backlog Item	User Story / Description	Priority
MILE-01	Create Milestone	As a freelancer, I want to create project milestones.	P0
MILE-02	Milestone Description	As a freelancer, I want to describe what each milestone represents.	P0
MILE-03	Milestone Due Date	As a freelancer, I want to assign a deadline to each milestone.	P0
MILE-04	Completion Status	As a freelancer, I want to mark milestones as completed/incomplete.	P0
MILE-05	Payment Amount	As a freelancer, I want to associate a payment amount with a milestone.	P0
MILE-06	Link Invoice	As a freelancer, I want to link a milestone to its invoice.	P0
MILE-07	Milestone Payment Status	As a freelancer, I want to see whether payment for a milestone is pending, paid or overdue.	P0

EPIC 8 — Automated Payment Reminders

ID	Backlog Item	User Story / Description	Priority
NOTIF-01	Upcoming Payment Reminder	As a freelancer, I want to be reminded before an invoice becomes due.	P0
NOTIF-02	Due-Today Reminder	As a freelancer, I want to know when an invoice is due today.	P0
NOTIF-03	Overdue Alert	As a freelancer, I want to be notified when an invoice becomes overdue.	P0
NOTIF-04	In-App Notifications	As a freelancer, I want reminders displayed inside the application.	P1
NOTIF-05	Email Notifications	As a freelancer, I want payment reminders delivered by email.	P0
NOTIF-06	Notification Delivery Logging	As the system, I want notification attempts recorded for monitoring.	P1

EPIC 9 — Unified Dashboard

ID	Backlog Item	User Story / Description	Priority
DASH-01	Dashboard	As a freelancer, I want a single dashboard showing the state of my freelance work.	P0
DASH-02	Active Projects	As a freelancer, I want to see my active projects.	P0
DASH-03	Contract Summary	As a freelancer, I want to see my uploaded contracts.	P1
DASH-04	Pending Invoice Summary	As a freelancer, I want to see pending invoices.	P0
DASH-05	Paid Invoice Summary	As a freelancer, I want to see paid invoices.	P0
DASH-06	Overdue Invoice Summary	As a freelancer, I want to immediately see overdue invoices.	P0
DASH-07	Upcoming Milestones	As a freelancer, I want to see upcoming milestones.	P0
DASH-08	Recent Activity	As a freelancer, I want to see recent project/account activity.	P1

EPIC 10 — Exportable Records & Dispute Evidence

ID	Backlog Item	User Story / Description	Priority
EXP-01	Export Contract History	As a freelancer, I want to export my contract history for documentation.	P0
EXP-02	Export Invoice Report	As a freelancer, I want to export invoice information.	P0
EXP-03	Export Payment History	As a freelancer, I want to export payment records.	P0
EXP-04	Export Milestone Records	As a freelancer, I want to export milestone information.	P1
EXP-05	Export Activity Logs	As a freelancer, I want to export relevant activity history.	P0
EXP-06	PDF Export	As a freelancer, I want records exported as PDF.	P0
EXP-07	CSV Export	As a freelancer, I want structured records exported as CSV.	P0
EXP-08	Export Audit Event	As the system, I want every export logged for security and accountability.	P0

EPIC 11 — Reporting & Analytics

ID	Backlog Item	User Story / Description	Priority
REP-01	Invoice Report	As a freelancer, I want to see how many invoices I've issued.	P1
REP-02	Payment Report	As a freelancer, I want to see total payments received.	P1
REP-03	Outstanding Payment Report	As a freelancer, I want to see outstanding payments.	P1
REP-04	Average Payment Time	As a freelancer, I want to understand average payment completion time.	P1
REP-05	Completed Projects	As a freelancer, I want to see my completed projects.	P1
REP-06	Monthly Earnings	As a freelancer, I want visibility into my earnings over time.	P1

EPIC 12 — Security, Audit & Compliance

ID	Backlog Item	User Story / Description	Priority
SEC-01	Role-Based Access Control	As the system, I want users restricted to authorized resources.	P0
SEC-02	Audit Logging	As the system, I want critical actions recorded for accountability.	P0
SEC-03	Encryption in Transit	As the system, I want communications protected using HTTPS/TLS.	P0
SEC-04	Encryption at Rest	As the system, I want sensitive data encrypted when stored.	P0
SEC-05	Secure File Access	As the system, I want stored documents protected against unauthorized access.	P0
SEC-06	Input Validation	As the system, I want user input validated to prevent malicious data.	P0
SEC-07	SQL Injection Protection	As the system, I want database queries protected against SQL injection.	P0
SEC-08	XSS Protection	As the system, I want user-controlled output protected against XSS.	P0
SEC-09	CSRF Protection	As the system, I want state-changing requests protected against CSRF.	P0
SEC-10	Secure Session Cookies	As the system, I want cookies configured with HttpOnly, Secure and SameSite controls.	P0
SEC-11	Security Headers	As the system, I want CSP/HSTS and other required security headers configured.	P0
SEC-12	Security Monitoring	As the system, I want suspicious activity monitored and logged.	P1

EPIC 13 — Backup, Recovery & Availability

ID	Backlog Item	User Story / Description	Priority
BACK-01	Automated Backups	As the system, I want daily database and contract-storage backups.	P0
BACK-02	Encrypted Backups	As the system, I want backup data encrypted.	P0
BACK-03	Separate Backup Location	As the system, I want backups stored separately from production.	P0
BACK-04	Immutable Backup	As the system, I want at least one immutable backup to protect against ransomware/malicious deletion.	P1
BACK-05	Restore Testing	As the system owner, I want backup restoration tested periodically.	P1
BACK-06	RTO/RPO	As the project team, we want defined recovery objectives for service restoration and data loss.	P1

EPIC 14 — Responsive Web Application

ID	Backlog Item	User Story / Description	Priority
UI-01	Responsive Dashboard	As a freelancer, I want the dashboard to work across screen sizes.	P0
UI-02	Responsive Contract Module	As a freelancer, I want contract management to work on desktop and mobile browsers.	P0
UI-03	Responsive Invoice Module	As a freelancer, I want invoice management to work on different devices.	P0
UI-04	Responsive Milestone Module	As a freelancer, I want milestone tracking accessible across devices.	P1
UI-05	Browser Compatibility	As a user, I want the application to function reliably on supported browsers.	P0

EPIC 15 — User Acceptance Testing

ID	Backlog Item	User Story / Description	Priority
UAT-01	UAT Test Plan	Define test scenarios for the MVP.	P0
UAT-02	Recruit Test Users	Select freelancers to test the MVP.	P0
UAT-03	Functional Testing	Validate core product functionality.	P0
UAT-04	Usability Testing	Evaluate whether users can complete key workflows.	P0
UAT-05	Bug Tracking	Record and prioritize discovered defects.	P0
UAT-06	User Feedback	Collect structured user feedback.	P0
UAT-07	MVP Refinement	Implement agreed changes based on testing.	P0
UAT-08	UAT Report	Produce the final user acceptance testing report.	P0

EPIC 16 — Data Standardisation (Future)

ID	Backlog Item	User Story / Description	Priority
DATA-01	Define standardized contract schema	Define the standardized internal contract data structure.	P2
DATA-02	Map external platform fields	Map external fields to internal fields.	P2
DATA-03	Test third-party API responses	Test integrations using Postman.	P2
DATA-04	Pandas transformation pipeline	Transform and standardize imported data.	P2
DATA-05	Validate imported records	Validate completeness, format, duplicates and suspicious responses.	P2
DATA-06	Store standardized records	Persist standardized imported records.	P2
DATA-07	Monitor synchronization	Record synchronization activity and errors.	P2

EPIC 17 — Future Integrations & Advanced Features

ID	Backlog Item	User Story / Description	Priority
FUT-01	Upwork integration	Future freelance-platform integration.	P2
FUT-02	Fiverr integration	Future freelance-platform integration.	P2
FUT-03	Freelancer.com integration	Future freelance-platform integration.	P2
FUT-04	Toptal integration	Future freelance-platform integration.	P2
FUT-05	Payment gateway integration	Future payment processing integration.	P2
FUT-06	Cryptocurrency payment tracking	Future payment feature.	P2
FUT-07	Tax calculation/filing	Future tax feature.	P2
FUT-08	AI contract generation	Future AI feature.	P2
FUT-09	Legal/dispute-resolution services	Future service integration.	P2
FUT-10	Native Android application	Future native mobile application.	P2
FUT-11	Native iOS application	Future native mobile application.	P2
FUT-12	Digital signatures	Future security enhancement.	P2
FUT-13	Immutable hash-based evidence	Future security enhancement.	P2
FUT-14	End-to-end encrypted document sharing	Future security enhancement.	P2
FUT-15	Payment-dispute anomaly detection	Future security enhancement.	P2
FUT-16	SIEM integration	Future security enhancement.	P2

MVP Definition of Done

1. Functionality is implemented.
2. Acceptance criteria are satisfied.
3. Applicable security requirements are implemented.
4. The feature works on the responsive web interface.
5. Relevant audit events are logged.
6. Error and edge cases are handled.
7. The feature passes QA testing.
8. No unresolved High/Critical security vulnerability remains.
9. Relevant UAT feedback has been addressed.
10. The feature is demonstrated successfully.

Recommended MVP Delivery Sequence

Authentication → Client/Project setup → Contract upload → Contract version history → Milestones → Invoice creation → Payment status → Automated reminders → Dashboard → Export/audit evidence → Reporting → Security hardening → UAT → MVP release

Backlog Traceability

Research finding → Product requirement → Epic → User story → Acceptance criteria → Development task → QA/UAT → KPI

Source baseline

This backlog was constructed from the approved Project Charter, User Stories/Acceptance Criteria, KPI Framework, Data Standardisation Process, and Security Requirements Document supplied for the Nova Collaborative project. It preserves the approved MVP boundary and treats excluded integrations/native apps as future backlog items.